

Translations (Shifts)

The Big Idea

Translations **slide** the graph without changing its shape. The “S” curve stays the same — it just moves to a new location.

Cubic Form	Cube Root Form	What moves?
$f(x) = (x - h)^3 + k$	$f(x) = \sqrt[3]{x - h} + k$	Center point goes to (h, k)

How to Find h and k

	What it does	Watch out!
h	Shifts left/right $h > 0$: right $h < 0$: left	$(x - 3)$ means $h = 3$ (right) $(x + 2)$ means $h = -2$ (left)
k	Shifts up/down $k > 0$: up $k < 0$: down	This one is straightforward! +5 means up 5, -3 means down 3

Transformation Cheat Note: To move your points, use this rule:

$(x, y) \longrightarrow (x + h, ay + k)$

(Note: For today’s lesson, $a = 1$)

Example 1: $f(x) = (x - 2)^3 + 1$ (Cubic)

Step 1: Find h and k

$h =$ _____ $k =$ _____

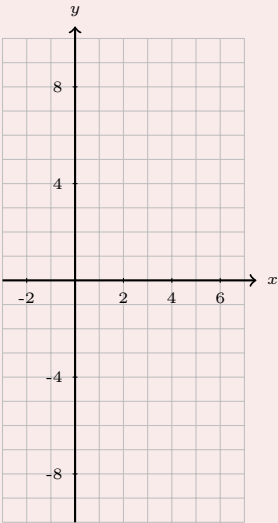
Step 2: Find the center point

Center: (,)

Step 3: Shift the anchor points

Apply $(x + h, y + k)$

Parent	Shifted
$(-2, -8)$	(,)
$(-1, -1)$	(,)
$(0, 0)$	(,)
$(1, 1)$	(,)
$(2, 8)$	(,)



Example 2: $f(x) = \sqrt[3]{x+3} - 2$ (Cube Root)

Step 1: Find h and k

$h = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ $k = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

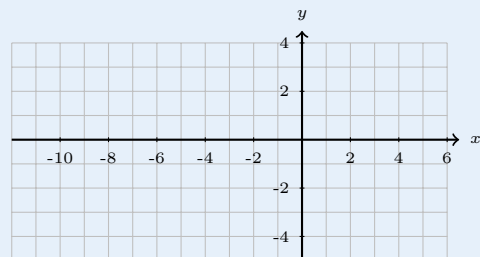
Step 2: Find the center point

Center: (,)

Step 3: Shift the anchor points

Apply $(x + h, y + k)$

Parent	Shifted
$(-8, -2)$	(,)
$(-1, -1)$	(,)
$(0, 0)$	(,)
$(1, 1)$	(,)
$(8, 2)$	(,)



Anchor Points to Memorize

Cubic: $f(x) = x^3$	Cube Root: $f(x) = \sqrt[3]{x}$
$(-2, -8), (-1, -1), (0, 0), (1, 1), (2, 8)$	$(-8, -2), (-1, -1), (0, 0), (1, 1), (8, 2)$

To shift: Add h to every x -coordinate. Add k to every y -coordinate.